

Substitute teacher packet

Where the class starts, what a team should be doing, and what to write down.

- Substitute packet
- Lessons
- All teams

Trail Crew: substitute teacher packet

Thank you for covering. This class is a software project class. Every student is on a team, every team is building one app, and the whole project runs on a website the teams already know how to use. You do not need to know how to code. You need to know where the class starts, what a team should be doing, and what to write down at the end. This packet is those three things.

The one address: `doubleblaze.solutions/trail-crew` . Everything below is one or two clicks from there. There are no student logins on this site.

Your day

Blacksburg Middle School bell schedule, 2026 to 2027. Students arrive in the room at the start of each period; you do not collect them from anywhere.

Period	Time	Class	What that means for you
Announcements	8:02 to 8:05		In their 1st period seats.
1st	8:05 to 8:55	Intro to Technology (7th and 8th)	Trail Crew. This packet.
2nd	8:58 to 9:48	Intro to Technology (7th and 8th)	Trail Crew. This packet.
3rd	9:51 to 10:41	Technology Exploration (6th)	A different course. Follow the teacher's note, or the line

Period	Time	Class	What that means for you
			below this table.
4th, part 1	10:44 to 11:11	Intro to Technology (7th and 8th)	Trail Crew. Start the period as normal.
Lunch B	11:11 to 11:41		Whole class goes to second lunch, 8th graders included. Back at 11:41.
4th, part 2	11:41 to 12:11	Same class returns	Pick up where they left off. Done when at 12:09.
5th	12:14 to 1:04	Planning, no students	Your break.
6th	1:07 to 1:57	Planning, no students	Your break.
7th	2:00 to 2:50	Intro to Technology (7th and 8th)	Trail Crew. This packet. Dismissal is 2:50.

3rd period, if there is no note: the 6th graders are not on Trail Crew.
Teacher's standing instruction for 3rd period: _____

4th period is the odd one. It is one class in two halves with lunch in the middle. Run Again and Watch before lunch, Do after lunch, and the Done when line at the very end. Tell them at 11:09 to save what they are doing; the board saves itself but Anvil and Figma do not always.

Passing time is three minutes. The next class arrives on the bell.

1. The shape of a period

Fifty minutes, the same every day, and the students know it:

Minutes	What happens	Your part
0 to 5	Again. Teams do yesterday's step again from memory, faster.	Start the clock. Say "again".
5 to 15	Watch. Somebody shows today's step on the projector.	See section 5. If there is no lesson running, skip this.
15 to 45	Do. Every team works its own project.	Walk the room. Ask the questions in section 4.
45 to 50	Done when. Each team says one line about what is true now.	Write the line down. Section 7.

Students sit in teams. A team is three to five people. Team names are on the website; the website never shows a student's name, and it must stay that way.

2. How students get to their work

1. Open doubleblaze.solutions/trail-crew. This is **the gallery**: one card per team, grouped by period.
2. Find the team's card. The card shows the app's name, the team's name, and a line that starts with what the team should do next.
3. Click **Project board** on the card. That is the team's home page for the period. Across the top of the board are links to every page the team has.

Every team has the same set of pages, made from the team's own documents. A team that is further along has more of them.

Page	What it is	When a student says...
Project board	One row per build card, with tick boxes. Students tick a line when it is true on the screen.	"Where do I start?" Here.
What next	One page that says the single next thing this team should do, and why.	"I do not know what to do." Open this.
Test plan	Their user stories turned into things to check.	"How do I know it works?"

Page	What it is	When a student says...
Build cards	One card per feature: the story, a Done when list, and which pattern to use.	"What am I building?"
Architecture	The screens to make and the exact names of everything on them.	"What do I call this button?"
Design brief	The same list, for the person drawing screens in Figma.	"What does the screen need?"
Design review	What matched and what did not, the last time their Figma was read.	"Is my design right?"
Pattern Book	The eighteen ways of doing things in Anvil, with code to look at.	"How do I make it save?"
Prototype	A clickable mock-up of their app, made from their stories.	"Can I see what it will look like?"

The chain is in that order on purpose. A student who cannot answer "what am I doing" should go **left** in the chain, not right.

3. What a team is doing, by stage

Each team's gallery card and board say which stage they are at. You do not have to judge this; the site does.

Stage on the card	What the team should be doing this period	Tool they use
User stories	Writing or fixing a story: who it is for, what they want, why, and how you would check it.	Write a story (link on the board). See section 6.
Build cards	Reading their cards and predicting the Done when lines. Usually waiting on the teacher to approve a story.	The build cards page.
Architecture	Reading the architecture page and setting a card to Building on the board.	The board.

Stage on the card	What the team should be doing this period	Tool they use
Figma and Anvil	The designer draws screens in Figma. The builders build them in Anvil. Most teams are here.	Figma, Anvil, and the Pattern Book.

Anvil is the tool they build in, at anvil.works. They have their own accounts and know how to open their app. **Figma** is the design tool. Teams usually have one designer and two or three builders, and they swap.

4. Walking the room: five questions that work

You do not need to know Anvil to help. These questions send a student to the right page, and the page does the rest.

1. **"What does your What next page say?"** If they cannot tell you, they have not opened it. Have them open it and read it to you.
2. **"Which card are you on, and which line of it are you making true?"**
Every student should be able to point at one line of one card.
3. **"Did you ask the helper?"** Every build page has a box at the bottom headed **Stuck?**. See below. A student who has not asked it has not tried.
4. **"Is that on your card?"** A student adding a feature that is not on a card is off the trail. Cards come from stories. New feature, new story first.
5. **"What is going to be true at the end of the period that is not true now?"** Ask this at minute 30. It is the Done when line, early.

The helper, called Spark

At the bottom of every build page is a box headed **Stuck?** with three tabs:

- **I do not know what to do:** tells them which page and pattern answers it. It will not write code for them. That refusal is the lesson.
- **I tried and it is not working:** paste the red error text or the code, and it explains and fixes. It answers fully when they include the story.
- **I am designing in Figma:** for the designer. It knows their design brief.

Two things to know: it will not write a story or a whole feature no matter how it is asked, and if a team fires questions at it very fast it says "That is a lot of

questions very fast. Give it a minute." That is normal.

5. If a lesson unit is running

The teacher may have left a note saying a lesson is on, with a unit name and a day number. Open `doubleblaze.solutions/lessons/index.html`, click the unit, click the day.

Each day page has the same four headings. **Watch** is a script: what to open, what to click, what to say, in order. It was written so that you can read it out loud on the projector without knowing the software. Do that. **Do** is the students' list; they can read it themselves. **Done when** is the line each team should be able to say at the end.

If a step in Watch needs the teacher's email or Claude Code, skip that step and say "your teacher does this part". Everything else in the script is yours.

If there is no note, there is no lesson. Teams work their projects. Sections 2 to 4 are the whole period.

6. Things students will ask you to do, and the answer

They ask	What to say
"Can you approve my story?"	No. Stories go to the teacher by email and the teacher approves them. Sending it now is the right thing; it waits in the queue.
"Can I change my story?"	Yes. On the build cards page there is a box headed Your story is wrong? . Rewrite it there. Nothing changes until the teacher approves.
"Can we add a feature?"	Write the story for it first, in Write a story from the board. That is how features start.
"Can you run the design review?"	No. Share the Figma file from the Share your design box on the design brief page; the teacher runs the review.

They ask	What to say
"Should I make my Figma file public?"	No. Never. Share it with the teacher's school email as a viewer. It says so on the page.
"The site is down."	Try <code>doubleblaze.solutions/trail-crew</code> again. If it truly will not load, teams can still work in Anvil and Figma. Write it in the note.
"Anvil shows red text."	Copy the red text into the I tried and it is not working tab on any of their build pages.
"Can I put my name on the design?"	No. Team name, product name, never a student's name.

7. What to leave for the teacher

One line per team is enough. Team name, what they said at Done when, and anything you had to say no to. A blank table:

Period	Team	Done when, in their words	Notes
1st			
1st			
1st			
2nd			
2nd			
2nd			
3rd	6th grade, whole class		
4th			
4th			

Period	Team	Done when, in their words	Notes
4th			
7th			
7th			
7th			

Also useful, if you have it: any team that spent the period without a card open, and any question the helper could not answer.

8. Things that are not your problem

- Nothing on the site needs grading, saving, or submitting. The board saves itself. The story studio sends by itself.
- You cannot break anything. Every page students can see is read-only or goes to the teacher for approval first.
- Stories sent today will not appear on the site today. They wait for the teacher. Tell the team that is expected.
- You do not need to know Anvil, Figma, Python, or what a user story is. The pages know. Your job is to send students to the right page and keep them on their card.

Thank you.